

DRAFT, NOT FOR SEND. VERIFY BOTH ABNS AND WHETHER FRED ZHENG EXISTS

PREPARED FOR MERCURY BUSINESS SALES AND VALUATION
6 AUGUST 2026 . MEASURED, NOT ESTIMATED

AI has given Mercury a leadership structure you never published

An owner thinking about selling asks ChatGPT who to use, and rings the name it gives. On 6 August we asked 59 times, and you did better than most. This is about what is said once you are found.

THE QUESTION YOUR BUYERS ARE ASKING

"Who are the best business brokers in Melbourne?"

WHAT CAME BACK

- 5 of 59** sampled answers named Mercury, at positions 5 to 8.
10 of 59 answers used your website as a source, one of the more-cited broker sites in the study.
5th your position on the ChatGPT app, in a shortlist of eight.

ONE THING IT SAID

Asked about Mercury, the assistants supplied a full leadership structure: who founded the firm, who is senior, who reports to whom.

Your people are real and correctly named. Your website gives none of them a job title.

So the hierarchy a prospective seller is being told about your firm did not come from you. Separately, two runs on the same afternoon gave two different ABNs for your business.

WHO IT NAMED INSTEAD

ChatGPT and Claude, sampled 59 times on 6 August 2026, also named: LINK Business Brokers, Benchmark Business Sales, Xclusive Business Sales, Aussie Business Sales, VIC Brokers, Morgan Business Sales, Trident Business Sales.

WHY THIS MATTERS

You are being found, which puts you ahead of most of the firms we screened. But someone selling a business they have built for twenty years wants to know exactly who will handle it. Right now that answer is being written by something other than you, and it has already invented one detail we can show you.

What this gives you

This is the only sales channel you cannot see: no impression, no click, no record, so nothing in your reporting will ever show you the buyer who asked a machine and was handed someone else's name. We measure what the assistants actually say when a buyer asks who to use, counted and dated, so you can read what they read. Already paying someone for search or AI work? Keep them. We tell them where to aim, and tell you whether it worked.

Why you, and who is doing this

You were chosen, not scraped. We measure a small number of firms whose work suggests they would actually want the answer, and we do it before making contact. That is why this page already exists.

Lee Powell runs every assessment himself. Thirty years in commercial software, creator of Scrivener for Windows and its million-plus writers, two companies built and sold, previously IBM, banking and pharmaceutical systems, Oxford masters on a full scholarship. Someone who can talk business and read the machine.

You will know what the machines say about your business before your competitors know about theirs. When something moves, you will be able to prove it moved and say when it started, because nobody can measure backwards and a baseline begun today is one they cannot buy at any price. And whatever this costs later, it will never cost you more than it does now.

Assessment A\$990, or A\$1,490 with a 90-day re-measure that puts a before and after on paper. Delivered personally within five business days. If the machines already have you covered, we will show you that, and there is nothing for you to buy.